has already started pre-orders from industries for its flexible OLED display ‘Youm’. The odd-sounding display is actually going to ship by the end of this year. But will we pocket a tablet by the end of this year? Probably not.

The current generation of flexible displays are ‘flexible’, not ‘foldable’ yet. They can bend to a good degree, but cannot be folded into two. Not yet. Instead, the current displays would be very good for devices where you need a ruggedness. Made of polyamide (a type of plastic), these displays

Light Touch projector

will not shatter like the glass displays of today.

It must also be noted that to actually have a foldable device, you also need to have foldable silicon. Although such foldable printed circuits have been around for a while, they are still very primitive. In February 2011, a group of European researchers led by scientists from Belgian nanotech research center ‘Imec’ introduced the world’s first foldable microprocessor made with organic semiconductors. The 8-bit microprocessor had only 4000 transistors and is a far cry from today’s advanced microprocessors with millions of transistors. But even if it has the power of a 70s processor, it is a beginning nonetheless. Pairing this flexible circuitry with equally flexible displays is one thing that is definitely going to happen in the future.

Hybrids

No talk about hybrids can now begin without reference to Tim Cook’s now popular comment at the latest quarterly earnings conference call by Apple:

“Anything can be forced to converge. The problem with that products is you begin to make trade-offs to an extent that pleases no one. You can